

design for time well spent using agent oriented system architecture

prepared for Jenny Rodenhouse

prepared by Damian Gill, Nicholas Jayanty,
and Christine Meinders

Research Protocol

Introduction

The time well spent movement believes in reimagining the attention economy and how we interact with our technology. Ensnared in an addictive relationship with the 'slot machine' in our pocket, we are poised to introduce an even greater technological evolution into our homes, workplace, vehicles, and the devices that connect us to each other and the world, artificial intelligence.

As interaction designers we are the ambassadors for the human experience in the development of technological products, services, and experiences, and have the opportunity to reimagine a more fulfilling relationship with the technology that is consciously and unconsciously shaping every aspect of our lives.

Research Hypothesis

Human beings express their intention through action, seldom aware that each action they take represents a sequences of events with profound implications, and seldom capable of communicating about these intentions directly. Through cataloguing the actions of the past and present with our participants, we have the opportunity to co-create a future vision for the role that artificial intelligence will play in our day to day.

The objective of this research is to surface the obscured intention each participant has to inform the visioning for an artificial intelligence that actively and passively enables users to extend this intention into every facet of their life.

Methodologies

A combination of exploratory user research and generative design activities help to guide the participant from the present, past and on to a future vision of how users will engage with each facet of the system, from setting it up, to correcting it, to interacting with other users.

The user interview questions are designed to elicit insights on the present. A timeline exercise connects them with the past identifying themes around intention, and a generative toolkit will reveal the agents required to express this intention via the system.

Interview

Moderator: Today we are going to imagine a future where we live side by side with units of artificial intelligence known as bots. We commonly see bots expressed as chatbots from customer support agents, to Facebook messenger and other communications tools. Before we do imagine that future, we wanted to talk to you about your day to day.

Present

Could you describe your day?

Describe what made it good?

Describe any roadblocks you may have experienced.

Describe what you would have done differently if you had foreseen the obstacle.

Describe the technology you used today? How did you use it?

Could you plot your day on this timeline?

Past

Describe a typical morning. How do you prepare to face the day?

Describe a typical work day.

Describe a typical evening.

Describe the five most important things you hope to accomplish each week? Why?

Describe the last productive day you had? How was it productive? Why?

Describe the last great day you experienced.

How did you know it was great? Why?

How do you relax after a day of work?

If you were in a bind and needed help, who would you reach out to for help? Why?

Tell us about the last friendship you cultivated? How did you know you wanted to invest the time?

Describe the last terrible day you experienced?

How did you know it was terrible? Why?

Describe your values. How did you arrive at them?

Future

Moderator: So now we're going to an exercise.

[Moderator reveals materials at this point]

This is a super bot. It is the coordinator of this system,

[Moderator reveals bot cards]

and these are the elements of artificial intelligence we're calling bots. Imagine a system of ants or bees where each bot has a role that it specifically carries out.

These are some of the themes that emerged from our discussion. Let's select the one that is most important to you.

[Participant selects a theme.]

Now imagine you have the ability to use this artificial intelligence to help you address this theme.

How would you go about it? Which of these bots would you use in the system? If you don't see one represented here, we can also create one.

Remember there is no right or wrong answer, this is not a test. We're merely interested in how you would approach addressing this theme with this new capability.

As you build out your super bot around this theme, would you please Think Aloud?

[Participant builds bot].

Moderator: Thank you. What theme is the next most important?

Remember, as you build out your super bot around this theme, would you please Think Aloud?

[Participant builds bot].

So we have a few general questions before we wrap up.

Describe your level of comfort with having a bot handle your schedule?

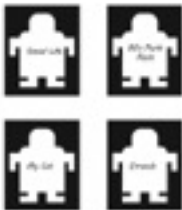
Describe your level of comfort with having a bot communicate with a friend? What about an employee? A client or boss?

Describe your level of comfort with having a bot handle your medical history and treatment.

Bot Activity



step 1: user fills out cards



step 2: cards placed in bots (paper folder with outline)



step 3: bots placed in superbot



step 4: introduce topic cards and introduce



step 5: add some topic cards to superbots

